

Muncie Sanitary District September 16, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pxYgVC6X9pE
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Board of Sanitary Commissioners: Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: September 16, 2026

Body: Board of Sanitary Commissioners (Muncie, Indiana)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or separate committee work session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at **00:00:03** on September 16, 2026, by the presiding officer of the Board of Sanitary Commissioners, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Unnamed board president, Mr. Clark, Mr. Selby, and Mr. Overton.
 - *Members Absent:* Mr. David Smith (excused due to illness).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The board considered the minutes from the September 2, 2026 meeting. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:02:37](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:02:43](#) Register of Claims

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer / Board leadership.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed the register of claims totaling \$1,975,927.70. Board leadership highlighted a major payment of \$796,313 made to Bowen as part of long-term control plan work, noting that Bowen is keeping on schedule with IDEM requirements.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:03:37](#).

[00:08:44](#) Resolution 2026-06: Amending Personnel Policies Handbook

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator (with note of preparation by Mara).
- **Deliberation Summary:** District Administrator Rick Conrad explained that the resolution updates hiring policies by combining internal and districtwide job posting windows (previously 7 days internal then 7 days districtwide) to streamline hiring while maintaining internal department priority. Additionally, the text was amended to clarify that the board president generally hires the district administrator and department heads, while delegating other hiring responsibilities down to administrators and department heads (correcting language that erroneously suggested the board president personally hired every individual district position).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:01:58](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:00:57](#) **Rick Yanser** (Newsman, author) addressed the board regarding past disaster relief. He noted that Anderson contributed roughly a half-million dollars for local relief following extensive storm damage, and county officials recently added \$100,000 for small projects. He suggested the sanitary district consider similar local relief projects or direct benefits to protect local industries (such as preventing electrical box flooding like what occurred at Progress Rail). He also thanked the board for assisting Trinity Church, noting

its historical landmark status and connection to civil rights leader JC Williams in the 1960s.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **District Administrator Update (Rick Conrad):**
 - Tilton construction work by the district is wrapping up; crews will move on to areas on Walnut, downtown, Oakwood, and cleaning on the Gallard (with specific traffic restrictions posted on Facebook).
 - Flood-related cleanup is nearing completion outside of hardest-hit areas; dumpsters and curbside pickup will continue for another week or two before anticipated wrapping up by the next meeting. Departments are compiling costs for potential FEMA reimbursement.
 - Upcoming events include the White River Cleanup through Muncie Delaware Clean and Beautiful at Westside Park (Saturday at 8 a.m., including lunch), the employee health fair on Tuesday, and neighborhood cleanups this weekend (Industry and McKinley neighborhoods) and next Saturday (Old West End and Whitley).
 - **Sanitation Superintendent Introduction:** Rick Conrad formally introduced Tammy Branson as the new Superintendent of Sanitation and Recycling. Branson has served the sanitary district for 25<U+2013>26 years (most recently as office manager and interim superintendent over the past two months). Branson briefly addressed the board, emphasizing budgetary foundations, streamlining operational costs, safety, and efficiency.
 - **Board Recognition:** The board commended the Bureau of Water Quality and its staff (mentioning Chuck, Shelby, Drew, Brandon, Laura, Courtney, and local interns) for their award-winning water quality work, upcoming fats/oils/grease collection logistics, and pond stocking/recreation efforts at Till Pond.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by voice vote **00:03:15**.